unit 1 CD1

Conversation track 1, 3, 4

Annabel and Alistair share a flat in London. Annabel wants to talk about the chores.

Annabel: Alistair, have you got a minute? It's about the kitchen.

Alistair: Uh-oh. That sounds serious. Is it the washing-up again?

Annabel: Well, yes. It's **high time** we **sorted** out a proper rota, don't you think?

Alistair: Fair enough. But **I'd rather** we **didn't** make it too strict.

Annabel: Fine by me. **I'd just rather** you **didn't** leave pans soaking for three days.

Alistair: Guilty as charged. They do tend to pile up, I'll admit.

Annabel: So how about you handle the washing-up, and I'll take the bins out?

Alistair: Deal. And **it's about time** we **bought** a dishwasher, frankly.

Annabel: Now you're talking! I'll look into it this weekend.

Alistair: Brilliant. Consider the rota officially up and running!

Study Notes

Guilty as charged.
Ừ, lỗi của tôi, tôi nhận.
Thành ngữ vui (gốc là lời tuyên có tội ở toà) để thừa nhận mình sai một cách hài hước.
Cách nói tương đương: I hold my hands up.

Now you're talking!
Thế mới phải chứ!
Dùng khi người kia đưa ra một đề xuất mà mình rất thích.
Cách nói tương đương: That's more like it!

Speak Like a Native track 2

1. It's high time we sorted out a proper rota, don't you think?

linking: "sorted_out"
change: "don't_you" (t + y → "ch")
weak: "we", "a"
strong: "high time", "proper rota"

Giọng Ireland đọc rõ /r/: "sorted out" → "sor-tị-đao". "don't you" đọc thành "đôn-chu". Câu hỏi đuôi xuống giọng vì người nói mong được đồng ý.

2. I'd just rather you didn't leave pans soaking for three days.

change: "just rather" (mất âm t)
strong: "didn't", "pans", "three days"

"just rather" đọc thành "jơs-ra-đơr". Nhấn "didn't" để nói rõ điều mình không muốn, nhưng giữ giọng nhẹ nhàng để lời phàn nàn vẫn lịch sự.

3. Guilty as charged.

linking: "Guilty_as"
strong: "Guilty", "charged"

Chữ "u" trong "guilty" câm: /ˈgɪlti/. "charged" chỉ có một âm tiết, đuôi -ed đọc /d/: "cha:jd".

• Giọng Ireland (Annabel) đọc rõ /r/ sau nguyên âm (sorted, proper); giọng Anh (Alistair) thì không: charged → "cha:jd".
• Khi phàn nàn lịch sự, nhấn vào từ mang ý chính (didn't, high time) nhưng giữ giọng mềm.
• Âm /t/ đứng trước "you" biến thành "ch": don't you → "đôn-chu".
• Câu hỏi đuôi xuống giọng khi người nói chờ sự đồng tình, lên giọng khi thật sự muốn hỏi.

Grammar Focus

It's (high / about) time + chủ ngữ + quá khứ đơn

Nói việc lẽ ra phải làm từ lâu rồi. Động từ chia quá khứ nhưng nghĩa là hiện tại; "high time" mạnh hơn "about time".

It's **high time** you **got** a proper job.
It's about time they **fixed** that road.

would rather + chủ ngữ + quá khứ đơn

Cách lịch sự, gián tiếp để nói mình muốn người khác làm hoặc đừng làm gì. Nói về chính mình thì dùng would rather + động từ nguyên mẫu.

I'd rather you **didn't** smoke in here.
I'd rather stay in tonight, if you don't mind.

Role Play track 6

A: Alistair, have you got a minute? It's about the kitchen.

B: Uh-oh. That sounds serious. Is it the washing-up again?

A: Well, yes. It's high time we sorted out a proper rota, don't you think?

B: Fair enough. But I'd rather we didn't _____.

A: Fine by me. I'd just rather you didn't leave pans soaking for three days.

B: Guilty as charged. They do tend to _____, I'll admit.

A: So how about you handle the washing-up, and I'll take the bins out?

B: Deal. And it's about time we _____, frankly.

A: Now you're talking! I'll look into it this weekend.

B: Brilliant. Consider the rota officially up and running!

Substitution Drill track 7

1. But I'd rather we didn't **make it too strict**.
   a. turn it into a big deal
   b. make it too complicated
   c. argue about it

2. They do tend to **pile up**, I'll admit.
   a. get forgotten
   b. slip my mind
   c. sit there for ages

3. And it's about time we **bought a dishwasher**, frankly.
   a. hired a cleaner
   b. got a bigger sink
   c. replaced that old kettle